Statement of Purpose

Bhumika V S · MSc International Accounting and Analytics (Pathway A) · University of Galway · September 2027 intake

Every week on Amazon's Global Seller Risk & Compliance team, I review cases where one misread document can decide whether a seller may keep trading on the platform. My job is to audit those decisions: to test the evidence against policy, find out why an error happened, and make sure it does not happen again. Before Amazon, at EY, I worked on a different version of the same problem. I tracked the compensation of a pharmaceutical client's international assignees across several countries so that their tax returns would be correct and filed on time. In both roles, the quality of the outcome depended less on the policy than on how reliable the data underneath it was. That observation is why I am applying for the MSc in International Accounting and Analytics (Pathway A) at the University of Galway.

I have been a Senior Compliance Associate at Amazon since July 2024. I lead compliance and quality audits across seller, product and regulatory-risk workflows. When defects recur, I run the root-cause analysis and turn the findings into corrective and preventive actions with our Operations, Quality and Policy teams. Some of the most useful work has been unglamorous. Improving the validation steps and workflow around our product-compliance database raised its accuracy by 12%. Rewriting how audit findings are summarised for leadership cut their review time by 13%. I also run calibration sessions and mentor newer associates, and our team's compliance-accuracy metrics improved by 15% over that period. This work taught me to think in terms of controls: where a process can fail, how a failure would be detected, and what evidence would convince an auditor that the control actually works.

My first role, as a Tax Analyst in EY's People Advisory Services, introduced me to cross-border taxation. I managed the assignment lifecycle for a multinational pharmaceutical client's international assignees, from initiation and compensation tracking to repatriation and annual compliance. I also maintained the compensation tracker that country teams relied on to prepare returns. I learned how a single income figure is treated differently across jurisdictions, and how a small reconciliation error in a spreadsheet becomes a filing problem months later. Reviewing processes across country practices also showed me that engagement profitability depends on clean, well-structured data as much as on technical tax knowledge.

I already hold an MBA, so I want to explain clearly why I am seeking a second master's degree. My MBA at Dayananda Sagar College of Engineering gave me a broad view of strategy, finance and organisational behaviour, and it helped me move into roles with more responsibility. It did not give me technical depth. The questions I now face require specialist training in accounting and analytics, not more general management. How do you design a control that tests itself? How do you analyse a full population of transactions instead of a sample? How do international reporting and assurance standards apply to data that crosses borders? I do not want to repeat my MBA. I want to add the technical layer that turns operational compliance experience into the judgement of a risk and reporting professional.

The University of Galway's programme matches that need closely. *Advanced International Financial Reporting and Analysis* and *Auditing and Assurance II* would formalise the reporting and assurance standards I have so far applied informally. *Data Science and Big Data Analytics* would take my basic Python and SQL, which I currently use for data checks, to the level where I can build analytical tests over whole datasets. The *AI for Business* elective is directly relevant to the automated decision systems I audit at Amazon. I also value that Pathway A is designed for business graduates who have already studied accounting. It builds on my foundation rather than restarting it, and the professional summer schools would help me present that learning to Irish employers.

I am academically prepared for this level of study. I completed my B.Com at Seshadripuram Institute of Commerce and Management with a CGPA of 8.43/10, studying Financial Accounting, Management Accounting, Business Finance, Taxation and Commercial Law. During my undergraduate years I ranked 600th of about 450,000 candidates in the All India COMEX Examination. My MBA (CGPA 7.82/10) added quantitative methods and case-based analysis. Since then I have completed courses in Financial Risk Analytics and Financial Accounting with Great Learning and in banking operations with Milestone Academy, and I use Advanced Excel, SQL and Python in my daily work.

After graduating, I plan to use the Stamp 1G permission to build Irish experience in tax, regulatory reporting or risk. My first targets are the tax and risk advisory practices of the Big 4 and mid-tier firms in Galway and Dublin, and the risk, trust-and-safety and tax teams of technology companies with EMEA headquarters in Ireland, where my combination of platform-compliance and cross-border tax experience is uncommon. Within five years, I aim to be a Senior Compliance and Risk Manager leading a team that designs data-driven controls and reporting for a multinational. I also intend to begin a professional accounting qualification using the exemptions this programme provides.

I bring practical experience of how compliance works, and how it fails, inside two global organisations. I also bring a strong commerce foundation and a clear reason for specialising now. I will contribute that perspective to seminars and group projects, and I am ready for the pace of a one-year programme. I would be grateful for the opportunity to study at the University of Galway.

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